at the State Department were so eager to improve relations with the People's Republic of China that they pressed me to back away from this pledge of support. I felt we had an obligation to the people of Taiwan, and no one was going to keep us from meeting it.

During that first year, Haig threatened several times to quit, but I talked him out of it. In June of 1982, as the Falklands crisis was coming to an end, he issued the same threat to senior members of the White House staff, claiming they were invading his turf. When he came to the Oval Office the next day, I was prepared to accept his resignation, but he didn't resign; instead, he launched into a bitter attack on the top staff and gave me a bill of particulars listing his complaints, which he asked me to correct. In fact, a few of his grievances were legitimate: One or more people in the White House were trying to do him in with malicious leaks to the press. Still, the jealousies and turf battles had gone too far. Two days later, apparently after he had decided I wasn't going to respond to his demands, he came to my office again, and this time submitted his resignation. I think he was hoping I would not accept it. But when I did, he didn't seem surprised. I had asked the staff to sound out George Shultz about becoming secretary of state; I called him and he accepted.

"This has been a heavy load," I wrote in my diary June 25.

> [Went] Up to Camp David where we were in time to see Al read his letter of resignation on TV. I'm told it was his fourth rewrite. Apparently his first was pretty strong, then he thought better of it. I must say it was okay, he gave only one reason and did say there was a disagreement on foreign policy. Actually, the only disagreement was over whether I made policy or the Secretary of State did.